Free downloadable E-Book

BUILD6

DISCOVER PURPOSE. BUILD SKILLS. LAUNCH YOUR FUTURE.

Unlocking Your Potential in High School and Beyond

YOU DON'T KNOW UNTIL YOU KNOW

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FREE EDITION | DISCOVER

Start where you are

Maybe you have a plan. Maybe you have five. Maybe you are tired of being asked what you want to do with your life. All three are valid starting points.

What you will be able to do

1. Name three interests and explain why one matters to you.
2. Ask a useful question and investigate it using evidence.
3. Connect an interest to a real task or career possibility.
4. Choose a safe, realistic next step for the coming week.

How to use this starter

Work on your own, with a trusted adult, or in a class. You can write, type, draw, or dictate your responses. You may keep personal reflections private and share only what you choose.

Before you begin: How confident do you feel exploring something unfamiliar? Circle 1–5. Why?
1 = I need support 5 = I can choose and take a step

One thing I hope to understand better:

THE SERIES AT A GLANCE

Your six-stage BUILD6 path

DISCOVER

Notice your interests, strengths, values, and questions.

DEVELOP

Practice communication, teamwork, confidence, and professional habits.

EXPLORE

Compare education, work, trades, entrepreneurship, and career possibilities.

CONNECT

Build relationships through thoughtful questions and respectful outreach.

EXPERIENCE

Apply what you learn through projects, service, and workplace exposure.

LAUNCH

Turn your evidence into a portfolio and a practical next-step plan.

This free edition starts with DISCOVER. You will also sample how curiosity leads into exploration and connection. You are allowed to revisit stages as your interests change.

The student who asked “why?”

Illustrative story: Maya watched a chemistry demonstration and asked, “Why does heat change how quickly the reaction happens?” Her teacher helped her find a source and suggested a small, supervised investigation.

Maya wrote down what she expected, what she observed, and what she still did not understand. She began noticing similar questions in cooking and food storage. Later, she asked a local professional how science was used in their work.

Her question did not instantly produce an internship or a perfect career plan. It gave her practice asking, checking, and following through. That was progress she could build on.

Your world is also a place to learn

A team practice, family responsibility, part-time job, game, repair, or volunteer shift can reveal what you like doing and which skills you want to develop.

Where have you noticed a problem, pattern, or question lately?

What could asking about it help you understand?

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Turn a question into an investigation

Use “why” to open possibilities

Start with “Why do some students avoid joining clubs?” Possible explanations might include transport, cost, schedule conflicts, unfamiliarity, or feeling unwelcome. These are possibilities to investigate, not conclusions.

Ask: What evidence would help? Whose experience is missing? Could there be another explanation? Stop repeating “why” when a different question would help more.

My question:

Two possible explanations - and what I would need to check:

A better follow-up question:

Try a 20-minute exploration: Read, observe safely, watch a credible demonstration, or speak with a trusted adult. Set a timer and record one finding and one unanswered question.

Your curiosity audit

List up to ten things you wonder about. They can be everyday questions, activities, problems, or careers. Small questions count.

What do I want to understand, try, build, improve, or help with?

Choose three. Mark one you could explore this week with the time and resources you already have.

My first choice and why it interests me:

Make the first step possible

A barrier is information about what support you need. It is not evidence that you cannot do something.

Match the barrier with an alternative

No money: Try a library resource, school activity, or free demonstration.
No transport: Start with a school-based or supervised online option.
No connections: Ask a teacher or counselor to introduce a suitable contact.
Unsure where to start: Choose one question and a 20-minute task.
Worried about judgment: Practice privately or with someone you trust.

What might get in my way?

A smaller step or support that would help:

Who could help me take that step safely?

Try a real-world decision

Choose one scenario. There may be several reasonable answers. Explain your reasoning rather than trying to guess the “right” response.

A. The team challenge

Your team keeps arriving late for a volunteer shift. Someone says the students do not care. What else could explain the pattern? What would you ask before suggesting a solution?

B. The career surprise

You love sports but do not want to play professionally. What behind-the-scenes tasks interest you: rehabilitation, event operations, data, media, coaching, or equipment? Choose one task to investigate.

C. The idea worth testing

Friends like something you make. Someone suggests selling it. Before spending money, what would you need to learn about demand, costs, time, and adult support?

My scenario, two questions, and a first step:

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Connect an interest to a possibility

A career title is a starting point. Investigate the actual tasks, preparation, and working conditions. Explore more than one pathway before drawing conclusions.

My interest and one role or real-world task connected to it:

What someone in this role actually does:

One skill or preparation requirement I discovered:

Source title, organization, and date checked:

Evidence check: Is the source credible and relevant? Is it current enough? Find a second source if an important claim is unclear or conflicting. If you use AI to brainstorm, verify factual claims and do not enter private information.

Start a useful conversation

Choose a teacher, counselor, coach, family member, or school-approved professional. You do not need to know an expert already.

Practice your introduction

“Hi, I’m ____. I’m exploring ____ because ____. Could I ask you about one task you do and one skill you use?”

Three questions worth asking

What does a typical task look like?
What surprised you when you started?
What is one safe way a high school student could learn more?

Who I could ask and how a trusted adult can help:

My introduction and best question:

Safety and respect: Use school-approved contact channels and adult support. Do not share your home address or sensitive information, meet unfamiliar adults alone, or interpret no reply as a judgment about you. Thank people for their time.

Your seven-day curiosity challenge

Pick one manageable exploration

Day 1: Choose a question.
Days 2–3: Spend 20 minutes checking a useful source.
Days 4–5: Try a safe small task or ask a trusted person.
Days 6–7: Record what changed and choose your next step.

My question and the action I will take:

When I will do it and the support I need:

Three things I learned:

One new question or possibility:

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My next-step card

Keep this page. It is evidence that you can move from wondering to doing.

An interest I want to explore further:

What I learned - and the evidence that supports it:

A skill I practiced and an example:

My next action, target date, and support person:

Check your progress: Rate your confidence again from 1–5. What changed?
Success means you asked, checked, reflected, and chose a step. A changed interest is a useful result too.

EDUCATOR GUIDE | 40 MINUTES

A ready-to-use teacher lesson

Purpose: Students turn an interest into an evidence-informed question and realistic action. Materials: this starter, writing tools, and optional access to approved research sources.

Teach the lesson

5 minutes: Normalize uncertainty; introduce the four learning outcomes.
7 minutes: Read Maya's story and distinguish a question from an assumption.
8 minutes: Complete the curiosity audit and choose one interest.
10 minutes: Investigate a source or discuss one scenario in pairs.
7 minutes: Complete the next-step card.
3 minutes: Exit ticket: one finding and one action.

Look for evidence of learning

A specific question; a relevant source or observation; reasoning that considers alternatives; and a feasible next action. Use "ready," "developing," or "needs support" for feedback. Do not grade a student's career choice or private disclosure.

Adapt without lowering the goal

Allow drawing, dictation, partner reading, or oral responses. Supply printed sources when internet access is limited. Students may use a fictional example. Extend the lesson with the seven-day challenge and a short follow-up reflection.

This is a suggested classroom lesson, not a claim of formal standards alignment or credit approval.

You started. What could come next?

You now have more than an idea: a question, evidence, a conversation plan, and a next step. The next level is practicing the skills that help you turn those discoveries into opportunities.

The planned full BUILD6 workbook

DISCOVER: Build your strengths, interests, and values profile.
DEVELOP: Practice communication, teamwork, and professional etiquette.
EXPLORE: Compare pathways, training, costs, and everyday work.
CONNECT: Write outreach messages and practice mentor conversations.
EXPERIENCE: Apply skills through projects and realistic scenarios.
LAUNCH: Build a resume, interview responses, portfolio, and 90-day plan.

Bring your next-step card with you

It becomes the first piece of your portfolio. The planned paid edition adds guided activities, reusable templates, and feedback tools; a separate educator package adds teaching materials and classroom licensing.

Ask about the next edition or a customized workshop:
Visit **build6.education** or email **jaime@linklakenorman.com**.

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